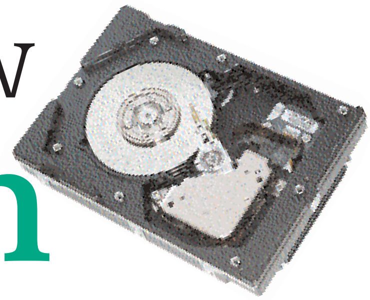
Storage in the new millennium



Higher areal density, faster spindle speeds, larger internal buffers, and lower failure rates all contribute to make hard drives faster and more reliable than ever before

The PC has made rapid advancements over the years and hard disk technology has improved steadily. Today's applications, be it games, multimedia, Internet or operating systems, all require fast, reliable and increasing storage solutions. Also the price of hard drives continues to decline and the cost per MB is at an all time low. The manufacturing technology has improved, leading to lower production costs, but so have market pressures and competition. Traditionally, product performance and quality determined which company captured an OEM's customers' business, but now performance and quality are a given and price is key. Drive prices have fallen to an all-time low in the personal computing end of the market with the advent of the sub Rs 30,000 personal computers. And more competition in the high-end enterprise sector is pressuring profit margins there too. Storage solutions for the new millennium are only going to get better.

Games

Gaming has been redefined with the invention of monstrous graphics processors that give you the ultimate 3D experiences. These games require large amounts of storage space, either for installation or for playing. Games that were produced in the last decade did not require much space, being mostly 2D games with limited image textures, and required very little graphics processing. The trailing edge of the last decade saw tremendous software and hardware development that lead rapid progress in game development. This, in effect, means that gaming evolved into a new entertainment segment where realistic and life-like experiences are the key aspects catered to.

Games demand space!

If you are a *Wolfenstein* fanatic then you can relate to the space requirements that the game demanded as it stepped from one version to another. The latest version, *Return to Castle Wolfenstein*, requires no less than 700 MB of space for a full install. Forced by these requirements you as a user need to upgrade your storage to load these games. The latest gaming engines have terrific space requirements as heavy graphics data is to be processed. Storage space is required to store and

Speedy Solutions for Gamers

Seagate's Barracuda ATA IV disc drives deliver 7,200-rpm performance for desktops and entry-level ATA servers, with capacities up to 80 GB. The products feature all FDB motors for the quietest acoustics in the industry, superior reliability and the Ultra ATA/100 interface. These drives include Seagate's exclusive 3D Defense System and a three-year limited warranty.

Features and benefits

- SoftSonic(TM) FDB motor on every drive—Quietest operation ever for a desktop 7,200-rpm drive
- 7,200-rpm desktop performance—High performance for PCs and entry-level ATA servers
- Ultra ATA/100 interface—Up to 100 MBps burst transfer rate
- 350 Gs non-operating shock—Tough ness and robustness
- 3D Defense System—Best reliability and handling damage protection
- 2 MB cache buffer—Fast data transfer rates
- DiscWizard software—Eases installation and maximises drive performance

Distinctions

- Best combination of performance, acoustics and robustness
- 3D Defense System to protect users' data and increase reliability
- 2.4 bels idle acoustics—industry's best
- DiscWizard software for easy installation
- Best-in-class non-operating shock for excellent reliability